

states ANDHRA PRADESH

The Party Begins

Chiranjeevi hits the road hoping to emulate NTR. But he could find the going tough as conditions that catapulted the legendary actor to political fame exist no more.

■ By Amarnath K. Menon

When actor-turned-politician Chiranjeevi hits the road and starts pumping flesh this month to spread the message of his fledgling party, the Praja Rajyam Party (PRP), he will discover to his shock that those who once romanced him onscreen are all set to contest his foray into politics. Not only are most of his former colleagues opposed to the PRP,

some of them have even been venomous in challenging his political credentials.

The list begins with Vijayashanti who has acted opposite Chiranjeevi in 19 out of his 148 films, more than any other Telugu film heroine. "He is no demigod like NTR (N.T. Rama Rao) and has no genuine concern for the poor," she thunders. A BJP supporter for long, the actress floated the Talli Telangana Party in December 2005 whose main plank is to vouch for a separate

